

Mesopotamia & Sumer -- Key Words

Name: _____

Word bank: alliance · artisan · city-state · cradle of civilization · cuneiform · epic · Fertile Crescent · hereditary · irrigation · Mesopotamia · monarchy · polytheism · scribe · silt · surplus · ziggurat

Write the word from the word bank that matches each meaning.

1. "the land between the rivers" (Greek); between the Tigris and Euphrates Rivers

2. A city and the lands around it, with its own government, not part of a larger state

3. A curving strip of good farmland from the Mediterranean Sea to the Persian Gulf

4. A government ruled by a king

5. A large temple; the name means "to rise high"; the top was the god's home

6. A long poem that tells the story of a hero

7. A name for Mesopotamia: the beginning of organized human society

8. A skilled worker who makes things like cloth, pottery, tools, and weapons

9. An agreement to help each other and protect common interests

10. An extra amount (of food)

11. An official record keeper

12. Passed down in a family: when the king died, his son took over

13. Small particles of soil left behind by floods; very good for farming

14. Sumerian writing made of wedge-shaped marks cut into damp clay with a sharp reed

15. Watering crops by digging canals that carry water from a water source to the fields

16. Worshipping many gods
